

04-botox-chronic-migraine-policy

Payer Prior Authorization Policy: OnabotulinumtoxinA (Botox) for Chronic Migraine

CPT Code: 64615 | **HCPDS Drug Code:** J0585 **Applicable ICD-10 codes:** G43.709 (Chronic migraine without aura, not intractable, without status migrainosus), G43.719 (with intractable pattern) **Policy Number:** NEURO-BTX-009 **Effective Date:** 2026-01-01

Purpose

Defines clinical criteria for prior authorization of onabotulinumtoxinA injections for chronic migraine prevention in adults.

Required Supporting Documentation

- Headache diary / frequency documentation** — A headache diary or detailed clinical documentation covering at least 3 consecutive months, showing ≥ 15 headache days per month, of which ≥ 8 days per month have migraine features (per ICHD-3 criteria), consistent with a chronic migraine diagnosis.
- Preventive medication trial failures** — Clinical notes documenting failure, intolerance, or contraindication to AT LEAST TWO different pharmacologic classes of migraine preventive therapy (e.g., beta-blockers, anticonvulsants such as topiramate or valproate, tricyclic antidepressants, or CGRP monoclonal antibodies), with specific drug names, trial duration, and the reason for discontinuation (lack of efficacy, adverse effect, or contraindication).
- Diagnostic confirmation and secondary-headache exclusion** — Documentation that the chronic migraine diagnosis meets ICHD-3 criteria, and that secondary headache causes have been considered/excluded — via neuroimaging if red-flag features are present (new focal deficit, thunderclap onset, papilledema), or via clinical exam findings if no red flags exist.
- Age documentation** — Documentation confirming the member is 18 years of age or older.
- No duplicate botulinum toxin therapy** — A statement confirming the member is not concurrently receiving another botulinum toxin product (e.g., for cervical dystonia or cosmetic use) that would result in cumulative dosing outside labeled limits.
- Continuation-of-therapy response documentation (if applicable)** — For members requesting a repeat/continuation cycle (not an initial request), documentation of at least a 30% reduction in monthly headache days following the prior treatment cycle, to justify continued therapy. Not required for initial requests.
- Prescriber qualification** — The request must be submitted by a neurologist or headache medicine specialist, OR by a primary care physician with an accompanying neurology consultation note supporting the diagnosis.

Exclusions

- Episodic migraine (< 15 headache days/month) is not covered under this policy; see policy NEURO-BTX-004 for CGRP antagonist criteria in episodic migraine.
- Requests exceeding the standard 155-unit, 31-injection-site protocol require an additional dosing justification addendum.